is mounted into a jacob's chuck in the tail stock – hang onto it – and advance it slowly.

"I do all my own sharpening and grinding," Michael tells us. "I use the wolverine system with the vary grind for all my fluted tools." Michael has made three different ¼in plywood jigs that mount on the wolverine grinding table secured with wing nuts. He continures: "They slip into the same position every time ensuring the same angle every time for my scrapers." This method makes it quick and simple for Michael to make repeat angles for his square end and angled scrapers, adding: "CBN wheels are a plus."

Highs and lows of turning

Michael told us that his lowest moment in turning was a painful one: "I smashed my finger and could not turn for a month. I turn almost every day so that month was torture." Aside from that, he has experienced many highs, including all the demos he has done for his clubs and at the Colorado and Utah symposiums. Becoming a woodturner has meant a lot to Michael: "It saved my life. It gave me a purpose and a sense of accomplishment, a sense of succeeding and lots of really good friends."

Self-promotion

These demos also give Michael a chance to promote his work. His pieces are also featured in three galleries in the US, The Studio on 6th in Springfield, Illinois, Turned Treasures in Belleville, Illinois and The Vault in Tuscola, Illinois. Michael also has a website, www.turningblind.com

Aims for the future

In the future, Michael wants to do more demos for clubs and at symposiums. Michael has, in fact, just been accepted to the 2016 AAW symposium in Atlanta, Georgia. He has also been invited to demonstrate in the Australian symposium in 2018 and is demonstrating in Vancouver, Canada and Seattle, Washington in 2016, and in 2017 at the Oregon symposium. Clearly Micheal has a busy few years coming up! "I love doing demos especially since it encourages clubs and other turners to help people with disabilities," he says. "My demos also encourage those with disabilities such as vision loss to not give up their love of woodturning. I show that there are other ways to achieve the same goal – turning."

As well as this, Michael's plans also include mastering new turning skills. "I see myself continually trying new techniques in woodturning. I recently started segmented turning and that has given me a new challenge that I can attempt to conquer." We look forward to seeing the results! ●

LIKES

- It's a very fulfilling hobby
- I can make quality gifts for charities and family and friends
- Woodturning meetings and symposiums – I love to learn
- Meeting people – woodturners are some of the nicest people
- Demos and teaching

DISLIKES

- Cracks
- Splits
- Knots
- Broken tools
- Cold weather
- Not enough time in a day to go to all the symposiums

HANDY HINTS

- I use all my safety equipment and I tape my fingers with masking tape so I can touch the bowl frequently and not burn my fingers
- Don't be afraid to try something new
- Don't be afraid of scrapers and sandpaper
- Go to as many demos as you can and join a club. I always learn something and so can you

TOP TECHNIQUES

- I don't have any special techniques. I just turn away everything that doesn't feel like a bowl!

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